Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**Business Management**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	**How has incorporating Corporate Social Responsibility principles into its business operations helped Starbucks to increase its revenue globally?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	Research Question: relevant to the topic (Starbucks is notoriously strong on CSR, so it is interesting to try to link this to its sales revenue i.e. to quantify its impact), clear (no ambiguity), focused (but not too narrow). Research Methods: robust secondary research, see bibliography, for example the academic article by Byus (though it is very dated), or an article from the International Journal of Economics and Management, but the incomplete referencing makes it hard to pin down. Structure: Structural conventions are followed. NOTE: The examiner could hesitate between 5 and 6, however the scholarly research should be stronger for 6.	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**6**	Knowledge: subject knowledge is comprehensive, relevant (marketing mix) and even going beyond the syllabus (e.g. 5I framework) Terminology: accurate and well used (e.g. about value chain) Concepts: Starbucks CSR is explicitly linked to the concept of sustainability; other concepts are well used too: impact, social value and ethics NOTE: In the [5-6] markband, the examiner could hesitate between 5 and 6, but the conceptual underpinning is so strong that 6 may be awarded (bearing in mind that, as stated in The Guide, "*awarding the top mark does not imply faultless performance*").	

C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**6**	Analysis: the analysis (of the data collected about Starbucks, from both internal and external sources) is very effective (both qualitatively and quantitatively with the sales forecast analysis) Line of argument: a very clear, sustained line of argument (linking the RQ, the findings and the conclusions) NOTE: In the [5-6] markband, the examiner could hesitate between 5 and 6, but there is no strong reason not to award 6 (for the two aspects of analysis and line of argument); again, as noted for criterion B, awarding the top mark does not imply faultless performance.
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**3**	Discussion: After the 9P analysis, there is a short discussion (p16-17) of the significance of Starbucks CSR innovations with some interesting quantitative data (Figure 4), but it remains rather brief; the conclusion also brings together the findings and discussing their significance, but this too remains rather brief. Evaluation: the final section called "evaluation" does not evaluate the effectiveness of the EE investigation, but the effectiveness of Starbucks CSR policy. NOTE: In the [3-4] markband, the examiner could hesitate between 3 and 4, but as there is no evaluation of the investigation at all. The mark of 3 seems "best fit".
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**2**	Evaluation: present (for example about too many variables), but remains limited. Growth: present (for example having learnt how to select credible sources) but remains limited. NOTE: It appears as if the student followed 3 successive reflections (former course format), which is not appropriate and prevents them from reflecting more holistically about the EE experience.
Total marks awarded	22/30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	This EE is very good in many respects (especially analysis and conceptual underpinning), it is unfortunate that the two evaluations are not stronger (in the EE itself: the evaluation of the effectiveness of the research and of	

	the essay in general; in the RFP: the evaluation of the candidate's learning and impact as a learner).